



## ACCORDING TO SOURCES, COMPOUND ARCHERS WILL BE INCLUDED IN TOPS WITHIN THE NEXT FEW MONTHS, EXTENDING THEIR SUPPORT BEYOND THE ASIAN GAMES

**Right moves:** Last week, the Indian compound mixed team of Rishabh Yadav and Jyothi Surekha Vennam (in pic) won gold at the Archery World Cup in Auburndale, USA. GETTY IMAGES

sources, compound archers will be included in TOPS within the next few months, extending their support beyond the Asian Games.

### Switching struggles

Until recently, several compound archers considered switching disciplines. Last year, Prathamesh Jawkar, part of India's gold-winning team at the Asian Games, announced his transition to recurve to chase his Olympic dream. He has since returned to compound.

Jiwanjot says he tried to dissuade the 20-year-old. "The two events are very different. The mechanisms for drawing and release are distinct.

When you switch, it's like starting from zero," he says.

So why do archers opt for compound archery in the first place?

According to Jiwanjot, despite its absence from the Olympics (until 2028), there were incentives. "Some states offer jobs and prize money for winning medals at the Asian level. It's also easier to pick up compound archery. You need at least six years of training to be consistent at a high level in recurve. In compound, you can reach a high level in about two years. If you need to shoot at least 400 arrows a day in recurve, you can get by with about 200-300 shots a day in compound," he says.

This means India's current dominance in compound archery isn't guaranteed to continue. "Three years is more than enough to develop an elite pool of talent in compound archery. The fact that the

competition will be a mixed team event also makes it challenging because it's possible for every country to produce one good male and female archer," Jiwanjot says.

### Olympic medals don't come easy

Past success in compound archery doesn't ensure future Olympic success. But it sure can be a marker.

A few days after the Olympic announcement, the Indian compound mixed team of Rishabh Yadav and Jyothi Surekha Vennam claimed the country's first gold medal of the 2025 season, edging past Chinese Taipei's Huang I-Jou and Chen Chieh-Lun 153-151 in the Stage 1 final of the Archery World Cup in Auburndale, USA.

In the men's compound team event, Abhishek Verma and Ojas Deotale secured a bronze, bringing India's overall tally to four medals — alongside a silver from the men's recurve team and another bronze in the men's individual recurve event.

With the Olympic inclusion, Jiwanjot expects competition to intensify. "Already, we have archers shooting 360/360 in qualification. I wouldn't be surprised if places are determined by the number of inner tens," he says.

While Jiwanjot remains cautious about future success, Rajat is simply grateful for the opportunity. "I have medals in every international competition, but the Olympics always felt like the one that wouldn't happen. It was an itch I couldn't scratch for reasons beyond my control. But now I know I have a real chance to make it happen," he says.